

K2P Displayed-Tree Clarification

Exact edge placement and four-switching derivation

Alec Kriebel [ORCID: 0009-0001-9320-500X](#)

August 2026

This note removes a compressed wording ambiguity in the exact $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{71})$ tree-theta-trinet witness. It changes no vector, matrix entry, factorization, or conclusion. The rooted network has arcs

$$\rho \rightarrow 1, \rho \rightarrow u, u \rightarrow p, u \rightarrow q, p \rightarrow r_2, p \rightarrow r_3, q \rightarrow r_2, q \rightarrow r_3, r_2 \rightarrow 2, r_3 \rightarrow 3,$$

and both inheritance probabilities are $1/2$.

Unambiguous edge placement.

arc	Fourier vector	arc	Fourier vector
$\rho \rightarrow 1$	K	$\rho \rightarrow u$	K
$u \rightarrow p$	U	$u \rightarrow q$	V
$p \rightarrow r_2$	S	$p \rightarrow r_3$	S
$q \rightarrow r_2$	T	$q \rightarrow r_3$	T
$r_2 \rightarrow 2$	K	$r_3 \rightarrow 3$	K

Thus both arcs out of p carry S , and both arcs out of q carry T .

Let (x, y, z) be the Fourier labels on leaves $1, 2, 3$. Consistency gives $x + y + z = A$, hence $x = y + z$. Every displayed tree has the following four common K -edge factors.

edge	labelled descendants	Fourier factor
$\rho \rightarrow 1$	$\{1\}$	K_x
$\rho \rightarrow u$	$\{2, 3\}$	$K_{y+z} = K_x$
$r_2 \rightarrow 2$	$\{2\}$	K_y
$r_3 \rightarrow 3$	$\{3\}$	K_z

Their common product is

$$K_x K_{y+z} K_y K_z = K_x^2 K_y K_z.$$

Four switchings. Deleting one incoming edge at each reticulation gives:

parent at r_2	parent at r_3	desc($u \rightarrow p$)	desc($u \rightarrow q$)	core monomial
p	p	$\{2, 3\}$	$\emptyset$	$S_y S_z U_{y+z}$
p	q	$\{2\}$	$\{3\}$	$S_y T_z U_y V_z$
q	p	$\{3\}$	$\{2\}$	$T_y S_z U_z V_y$
q	q	$\emptyset$	$\{2, 3\}$	$T_y T_z V_{y+z}$

If an edge has no labelled descendant, its Fourier label is A , so its factor is $U_A = 1$ or $V_A = 1$. Equivalently, that dangling branch disappears when the displayed tree is pruned to the labelled leaves. Each row has inheritance weight $1/4$, so after extracting the four common K -edge factors,

$$M_{y,z} = \frac{1}{4} (S_y S_z U_{y+z} + S_y T_z U_y V_z + T_y S_z U_z V_y + T_y T_z V_{y+z}).$$

Exact compact witness. In order (A, C, G, T) , use

$$\begin{aligned} K &= (1, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}), & U &= (1, \frac{4}{5}, \frac{19}{30}, \frac{4}{5}), & V &= (1, \frac{7}{240}, \frac{239}{360}, \frac{7}{240}), \\ S &= (1, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}), & T &= (1, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{27}, \frac{1}{3}). \end{aligned}$$

Every transition entry is positive. Direct substitution into the graph-derived formula gives

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 151/1440 & 3317/19440 & 151/1440 \\ 151/1440 & 71/1600 & 4681/172800 & 7597/259200 \\ 3317/19440 & 4681/172800 & 961/14400 & 4681/172800 \\ 151/1440 & 7597/259200 & 4681/172800 & 71/1600 \end{pmatrix}.$$

In particular,

$$M_{A,C} = \frac{151}{1440}, \quad M_{C,C} = \frac{71}{1600}.$$

Writing $\eta = \sqrt{71}$ and

$$P = (1, \frac{151}{36\eta}, \frac{107}{162}, \frac{151}{36\eta}), \quad R = (1, \frac{\eta}{40}, \frac{31}{120}, \frac{\eta}{40}),$$

exact arithmetic gives $M_{y,z} = P_{y+z} R_y R_z$ for all y, z . The comparison-tree vectors are

$$\alpha = K^{\odot 2} \odot P = (1, \frac{151\eta}{10224}, \frac{107}{648}, \frac{151\eta}{10224}), \quad \beta = \gamma = K \odot R = (1, \frac{\eta}{80}, \frac{31}{240}, \frac{\eta}{80}).$$

Hence for every consistent (x, y, z) ,

$$q_{xyz}^{N_\theta} = K_x^2 K_y K_z M_{y,z} = \alpha_x \beta_y \gamma_z = q_{xyz}^T.$$

All 64 Fourier coordinates and all 64 pattern probabilities agree exactly, the source invariant Q vanishes, and the exact minimum pattern probability is

$$\frac{1188799}{79626240} > 0.$$

Independent checks. The verifier literally deletes the unselected incoming reticulation edges, reconstructs each retained graph, computes every edge label from its labelled descendants, and recovers the four monomials above. Independently of that Fourier factorization, it performs ordinary-state Markov pruning with the exact 4×4 K2P transition matrices on each of the four displayed rooted trees, averages their distributions, and compares with both the comparison tree and Fourier inversion. All 64 probabilities agree exactly. As a source-convention check, the same descendant-label rule reproduces all five explicit 3-sunlet Fourier coordinates displayed in Lemma 4.1 of arXiv:2607.12919v2; that level-one result is retained in Version 3.

The calculation is replayed with Python 3.10 or newer and the standard library:

```
python3 verify_k2p_displayed_trees.py.
```